

Professional Services SMB

Information Protection MVP for sellers, architects, and technical specialists

Client data protection

Protect client files, diligence packs, contracts, and advisor collaboration

Service-led motion

Workshop, deployment, external sharing controls, then managed service

Built-in ready

Tax IDs, passports, bank details, and addresses covered by built-in SITs

HOW TO READ THE EXAMPLES

The boxes below show common privacy, contractual, client-data, and records requirements in Professional Services.

ACCOUNTING & TAX SERVICES

Tax returns, audit workpapers, client financials, engagement letters

MANAGEMENT CONSULTING

Client deliverables, strategy decks, project plans, due diligence reports

IT SERVICES

SOW documents, architecture diagrams, migration plans, client system specs

MANAGED OUTSOURCED SERVICES

Client system data, SLA documentation, support case records, service delivery reports

ARCHITECTURE & ENGINEERING

Design drawings, client specifications, permit filings, contractor agreements

Why it matters for Professional Services SMBs

Client files, diligence packs, contracts, engagement workspaces, and advisor collaboration materials move through Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive every day — often across clients, counsel, auditors, regulators, and partner firms.

This MVP helps teams protect high-value client and business data in Microsoft 365 within 30 days while keeping day-to-day collaboration moving with trusted external partners.

Partner service motion (30–90 day path)

- ① On demand learning — [Implement Microsoft Purview Information Protection \(Microsoft Learn\)](#)
- ② Deploy — pilot on Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive · Pilot (Partner-led) · 2–4 weeks
- ③ Govern sharing — trusted external controls · Expansion (Partner-led) · 4–6 weeks
- ④ Managed service — tuning, data loss prevention, audit evidence · Ongoing (Partner-led)

LICENSING: BUSINESS PREMIUM + PURVIEW SUITE ADD-ON

Included in Business Premium (MVP)

- ✓ Manual + default sensitivity labels
- ✓ Built-in sensitive information types
- ✓ Data loss prevention for Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive
- ✓ Basic audit (180-day retention)
- ✓ Controlled external sharing

Purview Suite for Business Premium (Phase 2)

- ✓ Auto-labeling policies based on content and context
- ✓ Custom sensitive information types, exact data match, trainable classifiers
- ✓ Advanced data loss prevention for endpoints, Teams, and browsers
- ✓ Audit (Premium) (1-year retention, search)
- ✓ Insider Risk Management and Records Management
- ✓ Data Lifecycle Management
- ✓ Information Barriers
- ✓ Communication Compliance

RECOMMENDED FIRST CUSTOMER MOTION — 30-DAY MVP

1 DISCOVER (WEEK 1)

Map client-file exchange, engagement workspace locations, advisor and auditor sharing patterns, and HR hot spots. 60-minute discovery workshop.

2 DEPLOY (WEEKS 2–3)

Publish the 5-label model. Pilot on Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive. Turn on built-in detection, default labels, and controlled external sharing for clients and advisors.

3 PROVE (WEEK 4)

Create an evidence pack showing labeled content, remediated risky sharing, and encrypted privilege and HR files. Prepare Phase 2 options such as endpoint coverage, broader data loss prevention, and custom matter or engagement identifiers if needed.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES — 30 / 60 / 90 DAY CHECKPOINTS

30 days FOUNDATION (MICROSOFT-DELIVERED ASSETS)

- ✓ 5-label model live on Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive
- ✓ Built-in detection covering client and employee data in files
- ✓ Default labels applied to new content
- ✓ HR/payroll files encrypted with Highly Confidential

60 days CONTROLLED SHARING (Partner service opportunity)

- ✓ External sharing policies for clients, counsel, and auditors
- ✓ Privilege and litigation files under watermarking and encryption
- ✓ Client deliverables on auto-expire links for trusted partners
- ✓ Alerts on client-data exports leaving the organization

90 days EXPAND (Partner service opportunity)

- ✓ Audit evidence pack for GDPR and regulatory readiness reviews
- ✓ Custom detection for matter or engagement IDs if the data model needs it
- ✓ Endpoint labeling for field consultants and remote teams
- ✓ Decision point on Purview Suite for Business Premium for more automation and governance

Talk track for sellers, architects & specialists

“Professional Services SMBs need practical protection for client files, diligence packs, contracts, and engagement workspaces while still collaborating with clients, counsel, auditors, and partner firms. Purview lets them start with built-in detection and controlled external sharing now, then add custom matter or engagement identifiers only if the data model requires it.”

Discovery questions (Professional Services)

- Where do client records live — practice management, document management, CRM, or file shares?
- Which clients, counsel, auditors, or partner firms collaborate on engagement workspaces, diligence, or deliverables?
- Do you share contracts, advisory packs, or audit opinions with external parties?
- Are there matter IDs, engagement codes, or client identifiers that built-in detection will not catch?
- Who owns privilege, litigation, or HR files — and where are they stored?

Handle common objections

“We’re too small for this.” Business Premium already supports a practical 30-day starting point with built-in detection and labeling.

“NDAs already cover us.” NDAs do not stop accidental forwards or overshared links — controlled sharing does.

“Will this slow my users?” Default labels and built-in detection keep the pilot lightweight for end users.

Recommended next step

Run a 60-minute workshop to identify high-value data, external-sharing workflows, and the scope for a 30-day pilot.

TOP DATA TYPES, LABEL FIT, AND EXAMPLE CUSTOMER MOTION

WORKFLOW OR CONTENT	HIGH-VALUE DATA (BUILT-IN / LABEL-LED / CUSTOM)	STARTING LABEL	MVP GUIDANCE
Client intake, matter management & file exchange	Built-in: Client names, email, phone, address, government ID, tax ID	CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Start with built-in Microsoft detection; protect client records first.
Client, counsel, auditor & opposing-party collaboration	Label-led: Engagement workspaces, client deliverables, contracts, diligence packs, auditor files	CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Controlled external sharing for trusted client and advisor workflows; block unmanaged forwards.
Payroll, HR, complaint & incident files	Built-in: Tax IDs, bank details, salary data, employee case information	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Strong early proof point for encryption and tighter access control.
Pricing, fees, engagement terms & proposal documents	Label-led: Fee schedules, proposals, engagement letters, rate cards, pitch decks	CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Start with content labeling and default labels, then add contextual rules later if needed.
Privilege, litigation & regulatory filings	Built-in: Legal matters, regulator responses, settlement records, privilege logs	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Apply encryption and watermarking, with tightly scoped permissions for legal and compliance teams.
Client deliverable & partner firm exchange	Label-led: Final reports, advisory packs, audit opinions, co-counsel briefs, supplier collaboration	CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Controlled external sharing with trusted externals; auto-expiring links.
Published thought leadership & marketing collateral	Published articles, approved case studies, public presentations, firm brochures	PUBLIC	Keep external-ready content easy to share and clearly separated.
Internal operations & team coordination	Label-led: Meeting notes, internal project briefs, team SOPs, non-sensitive operational comms	GENERAL	Apply as the default email label; keep routine internal content lightly marked and easy to find.
Practice management & billing system workflows	Label-led: Time-tracking exports, billing system feeds, practice management reports where encryption causes downstream breakage	CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	Use only when encryption blocks a critical LOB workflow; document the exception and review quarterly.
Compliance tooling & regulatory reporting workflows	Label-led: Compliance-platform exports, regulatory-reporting feeds, or audit-trail records where HC encryption breaks critical tooling	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	Exception path only; marking without encryption. Requires IT sign-off and quarterly justification review.
Phase 2 expansion	Custom if needed: Matter IDs, engagement codes, client identifiers, diligence reference numbers	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Add custom detection or exact data match only if the client data model requires it.

RECOMMENDED 8-LABEL DEFEND-ALIGNED MODEL FOR PROFESSIONAL SERVICES SMB

LABEL	PROFESSIONAL SERVICES EXAMPLE CONTENT	PROTECTION BASELINE
PUBLIC	Published thought leadership, approved case studies, external marketing collateral	No encryption; external sharing allowed
GENERAL	Internal SOPs, routine team coordination, low-risk operating docs	No encryption; internal marking only. Default email label.
CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Client intake records, proposals, engagement letters, fee schedules, pricing, internal deliverable drafts	Marking + encryption; no external sharing. Default document label.
CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Client workspaces, co-counsel briefs, auditor diligence packs, partner firm deliverables, advisor collaboration	Named-user permissions for trusted externals; governed external sharing required.
CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	LOB or legacy workflows where encryption breaks practice management, billing, or time-tracking integrations	Marking only; no external sharing. Exception path; requires justification.
HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Payroll, incident files, privilege logs, regulator responses, settlement records, trade secrets	Strong encryption, watermark, block unmanaged sharing; no external access.
HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Regulator responses, legal holds, auditor diligence packs requiring trusted external access	Explicit named-user access only; auto-labeling via SITs recommended.
HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	Critical workflows where HC encryption breaks compliance or regulatory tooling	Marking only; no external sharing. Tightly controlled exception path.